was justification to their argument because, during that particular period, almost all countries tried to expand, establish alliances, and exploit resources. It helped them remain in a safe zone during the war and protect themselves from external aggression. But, the question also arose: which country should have that absolute Power to carry forward an order? And what gives one country the right to dominate or lead the international charge instead of another?

Which Countries Can Influence World Order?

IR theorists have debated the relations, structures, and hegemony prevalent within the international system. They discovered that these are some of the prominent features within international relations. Scholars like Hans J. Morgenthau (1948) and Kenneth Waltz (1979) argued that the hierarchy of the global system is based on the Power of certain select countries. A country with many resources tends to maintain or carry forward the world order, which implies its political, economic, and cultural authority. However, merely having a quantitative bulk of resources is insufficient to lead a country to a dominant position. For, Gilpin (2009), for instance, said that to handle the global order costs, the dominant state should be powerful enough; besides, it must have the resources of coerciveness to share the costs.

That means it should have the political, economic, and military resources to bear the cost of the world order and have the competence to develop credibility while leading other nations. Countries that maintain a great power status in the history of world affairs, for instance, have allocated a substantial military budget, but at the same time, have had a higher GDP growth rate compared to other countries. As scholars like Ivan Timofeev (2013) briefly elaborate:

> A superpower can project its influence globally in a wide range of fields at one point in time, i.e., in economics, politics, ideology, culture, etc. A great power has regional ambition in these areas or projects its influence globally in various fields.

Table 2.1 explains how historical influence on world order, selected countries/regions.

Table 2.1 Annual GDP growth rates of dominant countries between 1000 and 1998

Regions/countries	1000–1500	1500–1820	1820–1870	1870–1913	1913–1950	1950–1970	1973–1998
Western Europe	0.30	0.41	1.65	2.10	1.19	4.81	2.11
Western Offshoots[3]	0.07	0.78	4.33	3.92	2.81	4.03	2.98